INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

GUIDELINES FOR STRUCTURING AND FORMATTING ACADEMIC PAPERS AT IU INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

1 General information **1**

2 Formal requirements **2**

3 Structure of papers **3**

3.1 Structure and order 3

3.2 Components of an academic paper 3

List of Appendices **7**

1 General information

This document contains the central guidelines for the preparation of written academic papers. It includes both formal requirements such as formatting guidelines as well as general notes on the structure, layout and fundamental components of such papers. The appendices also include an overview of formal requirements, selected layout templates and transcription rules.

These guidelines apply to all **written** academic papers, for example advanced workbook, project report, practical reflection, case study, research essay, homework assignment and thesis.

The required **length** of individual assessments is specified in the respective examination guidelines. Failure to meet these requirements may result in a deduction of marks.

The first page counted towards the specified total number of pages is the “Introduction”. Figures and tables within the text are included in the page count. The table of contents, acknowledgements (if applicable), lists of figures and abbreviations, abstract, reference list and appendices are not counted.

Information on correct citation can be found in the **General Citation Guidelines**, which serves as the standard for IU International University and is updated regularly. It is based on the APA style (American Psychological Association) in its current version. For the preparation of written assignments at IU, the version of the guidelines and/or the citation guide that is valid at the time of submission of the first attempt of the assignment applies.

You can find guidance on gender-sensitive language in the **Guidelines to gender-sensitive and inclusive language for employees, students and teachers at the IU International University of Applied Sciences**. In general, we recommend using language creatively and considering alternatives to gendered forms. Often, sentence structures can be adjusted, gender-neutral formulations can be found, or sentences can be cleverly reworded. Using explicit “gendering” should only be chosen when no other formulation options are available. **For IU students**, there is **no general obligation to use gendered language**, unless it is part of the program requirements. This is usually determined by the instructor.

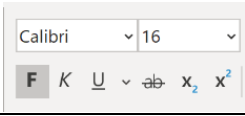
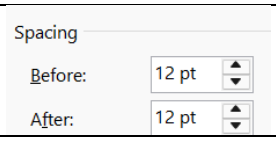
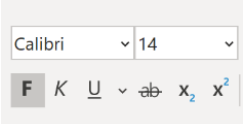
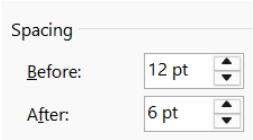
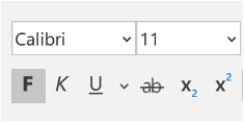
When preparing your written assignments, you should also follow the examination guidelines relevant to you, or, in the case of theses, the thesis handbook, as well as the current guidance on the use of AI.

2 Formal requirements[1]

The pages should be formatted single-sided with 1.5 line spacing, using a single-color black font with hyphenation (font size 11, Arial or a comparable sans-serif font such as Calibri). Footnotes should be written in Arial (or a comparable sans-serif font), font size 10, and justified. The font used in tables and figures may be smaller than 11 pt if necessary. The chosen font must be applied consistently throughout the entire document.

The main text should be justified, whereas headings and lists of contents should be left-aligned. In the reference list, from the second line of each entry onward, a hanging indent of 1.27 cm should be applied. Margins must be exactly 2.00 cm on all sides. Headings should be left-aligned and bold, with the following font sizes: level 1: 16 pt, level 2: 14 pt, level 3: 11 pt. Spacing before and after headings should be as follows: level 1: 12 pt before and after, levels 2 and 3: 12 pt before, 6 pt after. A new paragraph should not be indented, and there should be a 6 pt spacing after the line break.

Tab. 1 Formatting of headings in the text and text paragraphs

1 Heading		
1.1 Heading		
1.1.1 Heading		
Example of 6 pt spacing between two text paragraphs	This is an example of a paragraph in which a specific idea is presented. It is described in several sentences until the topic is fully developed. A new idea or a new subject area is presented in a new paragraph. This can be recognized by a 6 pt spacing between the last line of the previous paragraph and the first line of the new paragraph.	

Source: Own representation.

In the table of contents, only level 1 headings should be highlighted in bold (for example, **1 Introduction**), while headings of subsequent levels should be formatted without emphasis (for example, 1.1 Problem

[1] The formal requirements for a scientific paper at IU International University differ from the APA style in several aspects.

Statement).

Except for the title page, all pages should be numbered. Pages **before the main text** (e.g., title page, table of contents, lists of tables and abbreviations) should be numbered with uppercase Roman numerals (I, II, III, IV, etc.), with the page number not displayed on page I (title page).

The pages of the **main text** are numbered with Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3, etc.), starting with page 1. This is usually the section "1 Introduction." These page numbers continue sequentially until the end, including the appendix. The page numbers should be centered at the bottom of the page.

An overview of the formal requirements can be found in Appendix A.

3 Structure of papers

3.1 Structure and order

Scientific papers should follow the following formal structure:

- Title page (template according to guidelines)
- Acknowledgements (optional for theses; see Thesis Handbook)
- Gender disclaimer (optional)
- Abstract (for theses; see Thesis Handbook)
- Table of contents (including page numbers)
- List of figures (if there are three or more figures)
- List of tables (if there are three or more tables)
- List of abbreviations
- Main text (the body of the paper)
- References
- Appendix (with appendix list, if applicable)

3.2 Components of an academic paper

Title page

The title page is the first page with text that is seen by the reader. It should include only the following information:

- the full name of the higher education institution (no abbreviations, even if the logo is included)

- the type of assessment
- the course name (excluding final theses)
- the name of the degree program (no abbreviations)
- the title of the paper
- the name of the student
- the student registration number
- the name of the supervisor/ tutor, including the academic title (if known)
- the submission date

The title page is not listed as a separate item in the table of contents. A title page template can be found in Appendix B.

Table of Contents

The table of contents is part of the paper and should show how the topic has been understood. It must therefore reflect the logical structure of the paper and provide an overview of its contents.

The table of contents should list every chapter and every subsection together with the corresponding page numbers. If a section is subdivided, it must contain **at least two subsections**.

Poor:	Better:
1 Introduction	1 Introduction
1.1 Problem statement	1.1 Problem statement
2 Theoretical Framework	1.2 Objectives and Research Questions
	1.3 Structure of the Paper
	2 Theoretical Framework

It should be avoided that individual subsections are a verbatim repetition of the overarching section. The chapter heading must not repeat the topic of the paper. A chapter or subsection must be at least half a page in length. No extensive substantive text should appear between a chapter and a subsection (e.g., between Chapter 2 and Subchapter 2.1). However, a brief introduction to the subsections (approximately 2–3 sentences) may be included, summarizing the content of the subsections. In this case, the half-page rule does not apply.

The level of detail required in the table of contents should be discussed with the supervisor. As a rule, the paper should be structured using no more than three levels of headings (1 main heading, 1.1 section, 1.1.1

subsection). The chapter titles and subheadings, including their numbering, must correspond exactly to those used in the text.

The individual **chapters** in the body of the paper are numbered using Arabic numerals (e.g., 1 Introduction, 2 Theoretical Framework). Other components of the paper, such as the list of figures or the reference list, are given without numbering. The table of contents appears only as a heading on the page but is not listed as a separate entry within it.

List of Figures / List of Tables / List of Abbreviations

The list of figures, list of tables, and list of abbreviations help the reader to locate subject-related supplementary information. The lists of tables and figures as well as the list of abbreviations are placed in the front section of the paper. A list of tables must be included if there are three or more tables, and a list of figures must be included if there are three or more figures. For information on the numbering of these pages, see Chapter 3.

Detailed information on how to label figures can be found in the IU General Citation Guidelines. An example of a list of figures can be found in Appendix C.

Tables may be inserted into the main text if they complement it in a concise and clear manner. More extensive material should be placed in the appendix. Further detailed information on the labeling of tables can be found in the IU General Citation Guidelines.

The (sparingly) use of abbreviations is permitted provided they are generally common abbreviations (see Oxford English Dictionary), such as “etc.” or “e.g.” In addition, abbreviations commonly used in the field of business and economics (including those for academic journals, e.g., *DBW*, *ZfbF*) may be used. Company names should only be abbreviated in exceptional cases (for very long names); in such cases, consistency in wording and the inclusion of the legal form (e.g., *TUI AG* or *Infineon Technologies AG*) must be ensured. Abbreviations used merely for convenience are not permitted. All abbreviations used must be listed alphabetically in the list of abbreviations. Commonly used abbreviations (such as *e.g.* or *etc.*) should not be included in the list of abbreviations. An example of a list of abbreviations can be found in Appendix D.

Main Text

Detailed information on the structure of the main text can be found in the examination guidelines for the respective types of assessment or in the Thesis-Handbook.

References

A reference list is a mandatory component of every academic paper. It is the complete compilation of all academic publications and materials cited in the paper that have demonstrably been used or taken into

account in any form in the work.[2]

Appendices

The appendix contains all supplementary information that is not immediately necessary for understanding the main text of the paper but nevertheless appears important for overall comprehension.

It may therefore include extensive explanations that would disrupt the flow of the main text or unnecessarily enlarge footnotes, such as large tables, extensive statistical analyses, questionnaires, legal texts, excursuses, or interview transcripts[3].

Each appendix must be labeled as an “Appendix” with a consecutive identifier, for example: Appendix A, Appendix B, etc. The appendix must be referred to at least once in the text (e.g., “see Appendix A”). If there are multiple appendices, a list of appendices is required and must be inserted immediately before the appendices themselves. The pages of the appendix are numbered consecutively using Arabic numerals; however, page numbers for the individual appendices do not need to be included in the list of appendices.

[2] Exposé: Literature that is relevant to the planned paper but is not explicitly listed or cited in the exposé itself is not included in the reference list.
[3] The transcription rules can be found in Appendix E.

List of Appendices

Appendix A: Overview of Formal Requirements

Appendix B: Title Page Template (using a research essay as an example)

Appendix C: Sample List of Figures

Appendix D: Beispielhaftes Abkürzungsverzeichnis

Appendix E: Transcription Rules

Appendix A: Overview of Formal Requirements

Paper format	DIN A4
Margins	Top and bottom: 2.00 cm; left: 2.00 cm; right: 2.00 cm
Font type	▪ Arial or a comparable sans-serif font such as Calibri; uniform, single-color black font throughout the entire document ▪ Headings: left-aligned and bold; in the table of contents: only the first level in bold (e.g., **1 Introduction**, 1.1 Problem Statement) – see the sample table of contents of a bachelor's thesis in the Thesis-Handbook
Text alignment	▪ Body text: justified ▪ Headings and lists: left-aligned ▪ Reference list: from the second line of each entry, an indent of 1.27 cm
Font size	▪ Text: 11 pt ▪ Footnotes and source references below a figure or table: 10 pt ▪ Headings: Level 1: 16 pt, Level 2: 14 pt, Level 3: 11 pt ▪ Tables and figures: smaller than 11 pt if required
Line spacing	1.5 lines
Paragraphs	In the main text: ▪ A new paragraph begins without first-line indentation and is formatted with 6 pt spacing after the line break. ▪ Headings: Level 1: 12 pt before and after, Levels 2 and 3: 12 pt before, 6 pt after In the reference list: ▪ Level 1 chapter headings: 6 pt before
Heading levels	▪ Maximum of three levels (1 main heading, 1.1 section, 1.1.1 subsection) ▪ Only the chapters in the main text are numbered; other components of the paper, such as the list of figures or the reference list, are not numbered. ▪ Do not use underlining; use *italics* or **bold** sparingly to emphasize passages.
Page numbering	▪ Pages before the main text (e.g., title page, table of contents, list of tables, list of abbreviations): numbered with uppercase Roman numerals (I, II, III, IV, etc.); page numbering does not appear on page I (title page). ▪ Main text: numbered consecutively with Arabic numerals (1, 2, 3, etc.) through to the end, including the appendix. ▪ Page numbers should be centered at the bottom of the page.
Submission	The paper must be submitted digitally.

Appendix B: Title page template using a research essay as an example

Research essay

Methods of Individual and Group Counseling

IU International University of Applied Sciences

Degree programme: Social Work

The use of solution-focused brief counseling in individual counseling: opportunities and limitations in the psychosocial context

Max Mustermann

Matriculation Number: 123456

Supervisor/ Tutor: Prof. Dr. Simone Musterfrau

Submission date: March 31, 2025

Appendix C: Sample list of figures

Fig. 1 Consumer behavior in Germany ……..……...……..……..……..……..5

Fig. 2 Effects of digitalization on tourism ……...……..…….9

Fig. 3 The most important source markets of the destination Munich ……...……..15

Appendix D: Sample List of Abbreviations

APA	American Psychological Association
B2B	Business-to-Business
B2C	Business-to-Consumer
CDC	Centers for Disease Control and Prevention
CSR	Corporate Social Responsibility
DSM	Diagnostic and Statistical Manual of Mental Disorders
EU	European Union
GDP	Gross Domestic Product
HR	Human Resources
NGO	Non-Governmental Organization
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
PTSD	Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder
SFBC	Solution-Focused Brief Counseling
SME	Small and Medium-sized Enterprises
UN	United Nations
UNICEF	United Nations Children's Fund
WHO	World Health Organization

Appendix E: Transcription Rules[4]

Simple Transcription System

1. Transcription is verbatim, i.e., not phonetic and not summarized.
2. Contracted or slurred words are adapted to standard written English. For example, “gonna” becomes “going to” and “wanna” becomes “want to.” Sentence structure is retained even if it contains grammatical errors, e.g., “I went shop yesterday.”
3. Dialects are translated into standard English as literally as possible. If no unambiguous translation is possible, the dialect is retained, e.g., “I’m goin’ down the pub later.”
4. Colloquial particles such as “you know,” “right,” or “okay” are transcribed.
5. Stuttering is smoothed out or omitted; aborted words are ignored. Word repetitions are recorded only if they are used as a stylistic device for emphasis: “This is very, very important to me.”
6. Sentence fragments that are not completed are marked with the break symbol “/”.
7. Punctuation is smoothed for readability; that is, when there is a brief lowering of the voice or unclear emphasis, a period is used rather than a comma. Units of meaning should be preserved.
8. Backchannel signals such as “hm,” “uh-huh,” “yes,” or “right,” which do not interrupt the other person’s flow of speech, are not transcribed. They are transcribed only when they are given as a direct response to a question.
9. Pauses of approximately 3 seconds or longer are marked with “(…)”.
10. Particularly emphasized words or utterances are marked using CAPITAL LETTERS.
11. Each speaker contribution is given its own paragraph. A blank line is left between speakers. Even short interjections are transcribed in a separate paragraph. Time stamps are inserted at least at the end of each paragraph.
12. Emotional nonverbal expressions by the interviewee or the interviewer that support or clarify the statement (such as laughing or sighing) are noted in parentheses.
13. Unintelligible words are marked with “(unint.).” Longer unintelligible passages should, if possible, be accompanied by the reason, e.g., “(unint., background noise).” If a wording is assumed, the passage is placed in parentheses with a question mark, e.g., “(agreement?).” Unintelligible passages are provided with a time stamp if no further time stamp is set within one minute.
14. The interviewer is marked with “I:”, and the interviewee with “R:”. If there are multiple interviewees (e.g., in a group discussion), the abbreviation “R” is supplemented with a corresponding number or

[4] The rules presented here are a translated and slightly adapted excerpt from the following book: Dresing, T. & Pehl, T. (2024). *Praxisbuch Interview, Transkription & Analyse. Guidelines and Rule Systems for Qualitative Researchers* (9th edition). Dr. Dresing und Pehl GmbH (self-published). https://www.audiotranskription.de/wp-content/uploads/2024/06/Praxisbuch_09_02_Web2.pdf

name (“R1:”, “Alex:”).

15. The transcript is included in the appendix of the paper. The audio file may, upon request and in consultation with the instructor/supervisor, be submitted in addition to the transcription via email or, for example, via a OneDrive link.

4.1 Sample transcript following this rule system

I: So, are you planning layoffs? #00:32:02-0#

R: um (…) well (coughs) no. We will //reduce the expen- #00:36:03-4#

I: Yes, yes, but for three// years now you have made these these (promises?). #00:37:43-2#

R: (laughs) now you are starting THAT again. #00:38:23-1#

The time stamps refer to the beginning of the transcribed utterance.